XUEER LU

Journalism | Communications | Data

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Oakland, CA

EDUCATION

University of California, Berkeley

Master of Journalism | 2021 – 2023

Thesis: *Microplastics plague Monterey Bay. Better washing machines could be the solution.*

Nanjing University

Bachelor of Arts in English | 2016 - 2020

SKILLS

- **Languages**: English (fluent), Mandarin (native)
- **Journalism**: Strong written and verbal communications, editing, sourcing, relationship management, audience outreach, social media and multimedia
- **Data**: Data gathering, cleaning, wrangling and analysis, untangling problems in existing database, storytelling using data points
- **Technical**: Adobe InDesign, Illustrator, Photoshop, Canva, Mailchimp, Airtable, Google Sheets, Excel, Wordpress, Python, JavaScript, HTML/CSS
- **Events**: Event planning and coordination, public speaking

CERTIFICATIONS

- **Graduate Certificate in Applied Data Science** | University of California, Berkeley School of Information | 2022
- **China Accreditation Test for Translators and Interpreters Level 3 (English-Chinese translation)** | 2018

AWARDS

- Online Journalism Award, 2024, General Excellence for Micro Newsrooms
- California Journalism Awards, 2024, First Place for Informational Graphics

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Multimedia & Data Journalist

Mission Local | 2023 - Present | San Francisco, CA

- Report, write, and edit clear, deadline-driven news stories on politics, government, and community affairs
- Produce data-driven interactive stories that translate complex information into accessible, engaging narratives
- Lead multi-channel communications campaigns supporting fundraising, events, brand visibility, and community engagement
- Design and edit multi-lingual (Chinese/Spanish/English) print materials, newsletter, event promotions, social media copy, and donor communications
- Plan, promote, and host live forums, managing all logistics, messaging, and post-event follow-up
- Build and maintain digital content systems and dashboards to improve audience access and performance tracking
- Collaborate cross-functionally with editors, illustrators, developers, board of directors, and external partners to deliver campaigns and projects on deadline

Local News Reporter

UC Berkeley Investigative Reporting Program | 2023 | Berkeley, CA

- Reported and wrote news stories for local audiences in Richmond and Oakland
- Developed story pipelines and maintained organized contact databases to support editorial workflow
- Coordinated outreach and relationship-building with sources

Digital Design Intern

San Francisco Chronicle | 2022 | San Francisco, CA

- Collaborated across editorial, design, and engineering teams on interactive storytelling projects
- Improved internal content templates to support more efficient publishing and stronger audience engagement

Tech Reporter, Social Media Lead

Pandaily | 2020 - 2021 | Beijing, China

- Wrote daily articles translating complex tech and startup stories
- Managed social media and newsletter strategy across Twitter/X, Instagram, LinkedIn, and email, including content planning, scheduling, and performance reporting
- Launched and grew a Substack newsletter covering tech and startup trends Produced weekly social growth and SEO performance reports to inform content strategy
- Developed brand guidelines and trained incoming staff to ensure consistent voice across platforms

Data Reporter & Editor

NJU Factcheck, Nanjing University Journalism & Communications School | 2018 - 2020 | Nanjing, China

- Produced explanatory content, infographics, and data-driven stroies translating complex topics such as policies, criminal justice, and public health
- Supported editorial planning and asset organization for internal and external distribution